Jingwu in February 1952. The Chinese suggested that if India were to voluntarily withdraw its military escorts from Gyantse and Yadong, it would be viewed as a positive step by India towards settlement of the question of relations between India and China in Tibet. This was the last leverage of any consequence that India had in Tibet. On 29 September 1953, India agreed in principle, 'as a gesture of goodwill and friendship' [31] to the withdrawal of all military escorts in Tibet. Yet another unilateral concession was obtained by China without bloodshed, prior to the commencement of the talks. It was only after India had made substantial unilateral concessions on India's legal, military and political presence in Tibet that China, finally in September 1953, agreed to talks with India on Tibet in Beijing in December 1953.

Zhang Jingwu, Zhang Guohua, Yang Gongsu and others who were given the responsibility by the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China were asked to meet the Dalai Lama and the members of the Kashag (Tibetan government) and to collate all the documents relating to India and Tibet that were in Tibetan possession. It is through the Kashag that the Chinese learned about the precise details of the negotiations between Tibet and India that had led to the Simla Agreement of 1914 and the finalization of the McMahon Line. They were shown the original text of the agreement, as well as the map on which the McMahon Line was drawn as a thick red line. They learned that there was no mutually agreed accompanying description of the delimited boundary line in the 1914 Agreement, nor a delimitation protocol. The British had not undertaken delimitation and demarcation before they departed from India in 1947. The Tibetans also told them about their claims on Ladakh, Darjeeling and Tawang which they had raised with the Government of India in 1947, and of how India was enforcing its claim south of the McMahon Line by extending civil